

On the Menu

Imperialism & World War I · 1898–1919 | Standards US.19, US.20, US.21, US.22, US.23, US.24, US.25, US.26, US.27

Name _____

- Archive (J. Troop)
- Spark
- Navigator
- Notetaker

ESSENTIAL QUESTION

In one generation the United States went from healing its own wounds to reaching across the whole world — buying navies, taking islands, and finally sending two million young men to a war in the mud of France. When a country grows into a world power, who pays for the growth? And when it wins, what does it owe the people it now controls?

Hold this question the whole unit. You'll answer it at the end — in your own words, from the evidence.

1 Mission Vocabulary

Write what each word means as you meet it in the stories.

imperialism	_____	anti-imperialist	_____
	_____		_____
yellow journalism	_____	Big Stick diplomacy	_____
	_____		_____
militarism	_____	propaganda	_____
	_____		_____
self-determination	_____	League of Nations	_____
	_____		_____

2 Flight Log — every stop

One entry per landing. Jot what you *notice*, then answer the crew's debrief — the point isn't a right answer, it's your read of the evidence.

#	What Spark shows you & the crew's debrief	Your read & evidence
1	Analyze the economic, strategic, and ideological motives behind American imperialism, and the debate between imperialists and anti-imperialists. Notice: Picture a menu — but the items aren't food. They're countries. Cuba, Puerto Rico, the Philippines, Hawaii, all laid out like dishes, and a giant... Debrief: Name the three main motives for American imperialism, then explain the core argument the Anti-Imperialist League used against it. Whose reasoning do you find stronger, and why?	
2	Analyze the causes, course, and consequences of the Spanish-American War, and how Roosevelt's Big Stick and Taft's Dollar Diplomacy extended U.S.... Notice: A ship blows up in a harbor. Nobody knows exactly why. But two newspapers, locked in a war for readers, splash it across their front pages... Debrief: Explain how the Spanish-American War turned the U.S. into an imperial power, then compare Big Stick and Dollar Diplomacy as two ways of using that new power. Include the war's consequences for Filipinos.	
3	Analyze the long-term causes of World War I (MAIN) and the reasons the United States abandoned neutrality and entered the war. Notice: Europe in 1914 was a room full of people soaked in gasoline, and everyone was holding a match and swearing they'd only light it if someone else... Debrief: Explain the MAIN causes of World War I, then explain how the U.S. moved from neutrality to war. Identify the two events that most turned American opinion.	
4	Analyze the American military experience in World War I — trench warfare, deadly new technologies, and Pershing's American Expeditionary Forces —... Notice: Imagine a war where you live in a muddy ditch for months, where poison gas can roll in on the wind, where a machine gun can cut down a hundred men... Debrief: Describe what made World War I combat so deadly, and explain the role of the American Expeditionary Forces. Then explain why Alvin York's story is more complicated than 'brave soldier.'	
5	Analyze the World War I home front — women's expanded roles, mobilization and war bonds, and the Committee on Public Information's propaganda. Notice: Here's something they don't always tell you about war: most of the people fighting it never see the front. They're at home, and their whole world... Debrief: Describe two major ways World War I changed the American home front, then explain what the Committee on Public Information was and one reason it is controversial.	
6	Analyze Wilson's Fourteen Points, the Treaty of Versailles, and the debate over the League of Nations — including Tennessee's internationalist voice. Notice: The war is over. Ten million soldiers are dead. And an American president stands up and says: what if we made sure this never happens again? What... Debrief: Explain Wilson's Fourteen Points and the League of Nations, then explain why the U.S. Senate rejected the Treaty of Versailles. Was the Senate's decision wise or a mistake? Defend your answer.	

S Source Detective

Find this primary source in Unit 3 of your book, then work it like an investigator: **This 1898 political cartoon depicts Uncle Sam as a customer eyeing a menu of Spanish colonies like Cuba and the Philippines served by President McKinley, critiquing U.S. imperial ambitions during the Spanish-American War as covered in Tennessee US.26.**

1. Who made this, and when? Whose point of view does it show — and whose is missing?

2. Spark's question: *This is the 'menu' cartoon itself — Uncle Sam deciding which country to 'order,' served by President McKinley. Ask: the cartoonist drew whole...*

3. What does this source prove — and what does it *not* prove on its own?

A The Arc of the Union — *your call*

For each milestone, decide: did it move the country **toward** its founding promise — liberty and equality *for all* — or **away**? There's no answer key. Mark your read and back it with evidence.

Year	Milestone	Toward ↗ or away ↘?	Why — your evidence
1898	Spanish-American War: the U.S. becomes an empire		
1899	Philippine-American War		
1904	Panama Canal & the Roosevelt Corollary (Big Stick)		
1917	The United States enters World War I		
1918	The Fourteen Points: a new vision of peace		
1919	The Senate rejects the Treaty and the League		

B Debrief & Closing Argument

Units 1 and 2 asked what the country owed the people inside it. Unit 3 asks a bigger, harder version: what does a rising world power owe the...

Closing question: This unit put a hard idea on the table: a nation can grow more powerful at the same moment it does real harm to a people. Choose one event from this unit and argue two things at once — how it strengthened the United States, AND what it cost, and to whom. Then take a stand: was the trade worth it? Cite the unit. There's no answer key — make the case honestly.

Back to the Essential Question — your answer now: